LINE BY LINE - MACRO SCHEDULE

STATUS = PLANNED WORK — Milestone-led work periods. DONE = task sheet Complete; WIP = In Progress; PLAN = Ready to Start or future estimate. — Task status is a 10/24 snapshot, not a live sync. Later work periods remain proposed estimates; exact class submissions are on the Milestones tab.

SEP 2026 - MAY 2027 — Updated 10/24/2026. Dates are week-ending Tuesdays; current week ends 10/27. Phase colors describe work type, not completion. — Read task evidence in cell notes. A finished task or prototype does not mean its entire system, level, or department is complete.

CLASS MILESTONES						CLASS: Playable 9/17							CLASS: Midterm 10/29						CLASS: State of Game 12/10								CLASS: Alpha 1/28		Expo deadline TBA										CLASS: Beta 3/25								CLASS: Release Candidate 5/6
WEEK / CAPACITY			W1	W2 SHORT	W3	W4	W5	W6	W7 BREAK	W8	W9 CURRENT	W10	W11	W12 SHORT	W13	W14 BREAK	W15	W16	W17 BREAK	W18 BREAK	W19 BREAK	W20 BREAK	W21 SHORT	W22	W23	W24	W25 SHORT	W26	W27	W28 BREAK	W29	W30 BREAK	W31	W32	W33	W34	W35	W36	W37
AREA	**SCOPE**	**TASK**	09/01/2026	09/08/2026	09/15/2026	09/22/2026	09/29/2026	10/06/2026	10/13/2026	10/20/2026	10/27/2026	11/03/2026	11/10/2026	11/17/2026	11/24/2026	12/01/2026	12/08/2026	12/15/2026	12/22/2026	12/29/2026	01/05/2027	01/12/2027	01/19/2027	01/26/2027	02/02/2027	02/09/2027	02/16/2027	02/23/2027	03/02/2027	03/09/2027	03/16/2027	03/23/2027	03/30/2027	04/06/2027	04/13/2027	04/20/2027	04/27/2027	05/04/2027	05/11/2027
Production	Team	**Onboarding and sprint planning**	Onboard team				Weekly planning			Weekly planning / Midterm prep							Weekly planning						Weekly planning								Weekly planning		Weekly planning						
Game Design	Core loop	**Interaction, crossword, and dialogue loop**	Build core loop				Playtest and adjust			WIP: L2 confrontation / L3 crossword [1]		Add remaining mechanics					Add remaining mechanics						Check full game			Improve game feel					Improve game feel		Final tuning						
	Secondary mechanics	**Plan and test remaining mechanics**					DONE: police / hint ideation [2]			DONE: police prototype; PLAN: L2 confrontation [3]							Put in levels	Review					Test all puzzles			Test and improve					Test and improve		Final puzzle fixes						
Level Design	Level 1	**Balcony level**	Finish playable pass				DONE: balcony scene / puzzle changes [4]			Playtest and fix: verify level numbering [5]		Add art and audio					Add art and audio						Alpha review			Improve clarity					Improve clarity		Final polish						
	Level 2	**Blockout, story, and puzzle pass**			Plan		Improve blockout			DONE: L2 camera pass; PLAN: confrontation [6]		Add art and audio					Add art and audio						Alpha review			Playtest and improve					Playtest and improve		Final polish						
	Level 3	**Blockout, story, and puzzle pass**					Blockout			DONE: puzzle pass; WIP: crossword; PLAN: L3 in engine [7]		Add puzzles and story					Playtest						Alpha review			Playtest and improve					Playtest and improve		Final polish						
	Level 4	**Blockout, story, and puzzle pass**								PLAN: L4 blockout by 10/29	Blockout	Review and adjust					Add dialogue and mechanics						Alpha review			Playtest and improve					Playtest and improve		Final polish						
	Level 5	**Blockout and first puzzle pass**									PLAN: Idlede L5; blockout by 11/24	Blockout					Add first mechanics						Add story and test			Playtest and improve					Playtest and improve		Final polish						
	Level 6	**Blockout and first puzzle pass**										PROPOSED: L6 puzzles / scope					Early blockout						Finish first playable pass	Review		Playtest and improve					Playtest and improve		Final polish						
Narrative	Story	**Full story and level beats**	Fill story gaps				Review remaining beats			DONE: master-doc pass; HOLD: latest update [8]		Finish full story draft					Finish full story draft						Check story in game			Final dialogue changes					Final dialogue changes								
	Levels 1-2	**Dialogue writing and implementation**	Balcony dialogue			Level 2 draft				DONE: one L2 pass; WIP: Grace / L2 revisions [9]		Playtest and revise					Playtest and revise						Alpha check			Final dialogue pass					Final dialogue pass								
	Levels 3-4	**Dialogue writing and implementation**									PLAN: L2 aftermath / L3 intro; L3 draft by 11/10 [10]		Add Level 3 + draft Level 4				Put Level 4 dialogue in game						Alpha check			Final dialogue pass					Final dialogue pass								
	Levels 5-6	**Dialogue writing and implementation**											Draft remaining dialogue				Review drafts						Put dialogue in game	Check		Final dialogue pass					Final dialogue pass								
Engineering	Gameplay	**Interaction, crossword, and dialogue systems**	Build core systems				Connect systems			DONE: confrontation prototype; WIP: finish + fixes [11]		Test and stabilize					Test and stabilize						Finish systems			Fix and optimize					Fix and optimize		Final bug fixes						
	Tools	**Designer crossword and dialogue tools**			Plan tools		Build first tools			DONE: crossword docs; PLAN: debug panel; verify import tool [12]		Improve tool workflow					Improve tool workflow						Finish tools			Fix tool issues					Fix tool issues								
	Progression	**Quest system**					Plan quest flow			PLAN: quest first-pass check for Midterm		Test across levels					Test across levels						Finish quest system			Fix quest bugs					Fix quest bugs		Final checks						
	Saves	**Level-to-level save and load**					Plan saves			DONE: level loading setup; save/load unverified [13]		Test level transitions					Test level transitions						Finish save system			Test and fix					Test and fix		Final save checks						
	Performance	**Smooth gameplay and stable builds**										PLAN: stabilize systems / tools for 12/10					Check stability						Alpha fixes			Measure and optimize					Measure and optimize		Test on demo computer				BC build	Handoff	
UI / UX	Main screens	**Crossword, dialogue, journal, and HUD**			Explore styles		First layouts			DONE: journal drafts; PLAN: Journal-Main revisions [14]		Playtest screens					Playtest screens						Alpha screen checks			Improve UI					Improve UI		Final polish						
	Other screens	**Remaining screens and menus**								PLAN: remaining UI; verify implementation		First layouts					Put screens in game						Check all screens			Improve UI					Improve UI		Final polish						
	UI kit	**Shared UI style and assets**			Explore and choose style					DONE: flow / wireframes; PLAN: UI Kit v1 11/19 [15]		UI Kit v1					Use kit in game						UI Kit v2					Refine assets			Refine assets		Polish			Final UI kit			
Art	Style	**Concept art and art guide**	Balcony concepts and guide				Style guide			DONE: art guide; WIP: Grace / Irene concepts [16]		Art Bible and review					Art Bible and review						Final concepts																
Character Art	Sprites	**Character sprites for all levels**			First sprites		Make remaining sprites			PLAN: Margo chibi; verify sprite implementation [17]		Put sprites in game					Review in levels						Near-final pass			Final art fixes					Final art fixes		Last fixes						
	Models and animation	**Character models, rigs, and animations**					Model first characters			DONE: rig-base pass; WIP: rig / character revisions [18]		Model, rig, and animate					Model, rig, and animate						Review in game			Finish character assets					Finish character assets		Final art		Last fixes				
Environment Art	Balcony	**Level 1 environment and props**	Concepts and asset list				Make assets			DONE: remodel pass; PLAN: reTexture / pathtrace [19]		Put art in game					Put art in game						Lighting pass			Polish					Polish		Final fixes						
	Levels 2-4	**Environment assets and props**					First asset batches			PLAN: asset production; verify per-level coverage		Put art in levels					Put art in levels						Near-final pass			Finish art and lighting					Finish art and lighting		Final fixes						
	Levels 5-6	**Environment assets and props**										Concepts and asset lists					First asset batches						Put art in levels			Finish art and lighting					Finish art and lighting		Final fixes						
VFX	Feedback	**Puzzle and interaction effects**										List needed effects					Try first effects						Put first VFX in game			Test and improve					Test and improve		Final polish						
Audio	System	**FMOD and voice playback**	DONE: FMOD integration [20]				Voice playback system			DONE: audio integration; PLAN: loop / UI-SFX fixes [21]		Test audio in levels					Test audio in levels						Alpha audio checks			Fix audio issues					Fix audio issues		Final checks						
	SFX	**Interaction, puzzle, and UI sounds**	Audio direction and list				Make first SFX			DONE: SFX pass; PLAN: evidence pin / asset list [22]		Put audio in levels					Put audio in levels						First pass on all SFX			Final SFX pass					Final SFX pass		Final mix by 4/27 [23]						
	Music	**Music, ambience, and soundtrack**					Choose music direction			DONE: track drafts; PLAN: main / menu revisions [24]		Make music					Make music						Test tracks in game			Finish tracks					Finish tracks		Final mix by 4/27 [25]					Soundtrack release prep	
	Voice acting	**Casting, recording, and implementation**					Placeholder voice lines			WIP: voice / bark writing; recording unverified [26]		Cast all characters					Cast all characters						TARGET: Alpha VA* [27]			Put VA in game					Review lines		CLASS: final VO 4/1; pickups* [28]		Mix and check timing				
QA / Playtest	Regular testing	**Play through builds and track bugs**			Weekly tests and fixes					DONE: 10/13 tests; PLAN: 10/20 tests (dates stale) [29]							Weekly tests and fixes						Weekly tests and fixes								Weekly tests and fixes		Weekly tests and fixes					Daily final checks	
	Build checks	**Time reserved before presentations**			Playable						PLAN: Midterm build check before 10/29						SotG							Alpha								Beta prep		Beta check					BC check	
Usability	Player feedback	**Everybody Test and follow-up fixes**					Test	Test plan			WIP: RITE; PLAN: retest / update dates [30]			Test	Retest fixes			Results							Test			Test			Test								
Marketing	Brand	**Positioning and creative brief**					Positioning draft			DONE: prelim positioning [31]	DONE: prelim brief 10/22; PLAN: R2 10/29 [32]																													
	Socials	**Social accounts, screenshots, and outreach**					Set up socials and screenshots			PLAN: socials / screenshots; verify setup		Share progress					Share progress						Share progress								Share progress		Launch outreach						
	Logo and key art	**Logo and key art production**										Concepts					First art pass						TARGET: Alpha key art*		CLASS: R2 art 1/28	Text and choose		Final files			Final files		Prepare promo assets						
	Trailer	**Trailer planning, capture, and editing**															Early trailer ideas						TARGET: internal trailer draft*			Class storyboards		Capture gameplay			Rough cut		Second cut		Final capture and edit			CLASS: final trailer 4/29	Share	
	Web	**Steam page and website**					Draft page			PLAN: Steam setup by 10/29; verify status		About copy					PLAN: Steam live by 12/10						Update screenshots and copy								Website draft		First website		Final website			Final page checks	
Production	Expo	**Submission and booth materials**																					Plan demo			Check submission build	Expo date TBA	Plan booth materials			Plan booth materials		Make poster, cutouts, cards			Check booth and practice		Handoff	
	Wrap-up	**Reports and postmortems**																																	Gather notes		Reports / postmortems by 5/6		

LEGEND

Plan / first draft	Decide what to make or write the first version.
Blockout / try it	Make a rough version to test the idea.
Build / make it	Create the assets, content, or working system.
Put in game / test and fix	Connect the work, play it, and make changes.
Final polish	Improve the nearly finished work and fix remaining issues.
Deadline / build check	A named handoff or check. CLASS labels are class dates; build checks are internal.
Regular work	Work that repeats, such as playtests or weekly planning.
Break / no planned work	No new production scheduled. SHORT in the header means fewer available workdays.

PLANNING NOTES

How dates line up	Class presentations happen inside the week shown. Internal build checks are planned before the class date. Exact class submissions stay in the original milestone tab.
Past weeks	Completion evidence [33] — Open work and stale dates remain open. QA's 10/20 build tests and RITE work still show 10/13–10/20 dates. Engineering's sprint header says 10/06 while current tasks are dated 10/20–10/25. Use task rows, not the header.
Level 6	Level scope / numbering — DESIGN1D47 marks 'Block out for entire game' Complete (10/06–10/13), but this does not verify six playable levels. Task sheet calls Balcony Level 2; this schedule previously called it Level 1. Keep numbered milestone goals, and confirm the mapping before declaring per-level completion.
Voice acting - confirm	Your Alpha goals say all VA done, while the class final script is 3/25 and final VO is 4/1. Proposed: first recordings for Alpha, then revised lines/pickups. Confirm this plan. — Unresolved target: Alpha says all VA done. Current tasks cover character voices, barks and VO specs; recordings are not verified. Class final VO script is 3/25 and VO due 4/1. First recordings at Alpha plus later pickups is a proposed reconciliation, not an approved scope change.
Trailer / key art - confirm	Your Alpha goals include a trailer draft and final key art; class storyboard and art testing dates continue in February. Keep an internal Alpha version, then make the class revisions. — Unresolved target: Alpha asks for a trailer draft and final key art. Class R2 art is 1/28, tested final selection 2/11; storyboards 2/4 and 2/11, rough cut 3/11, final trailer 4/29. Keep Alpha targets flagged; distinguish internal drafts from later class finals.
Beta break	Spring break has no new production planned. Prepare the Beta candidate before break and reserve the presentation week for checks and urgent fixes.
Source and estimates	Sources / refresh — Milestone dates: Line By Line 2026-27 MILESTONES. Status: linked Task Tracking workbook, all eight department tabs, read 10/24/2026. Future periods are estimates; refresh after each sprint. Task sheet remains the source for assignments and individual task status.